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CENTER FOR ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL ADVANCEMENT
THE AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF KURDISTAN

Youth Entrepreneurship Program

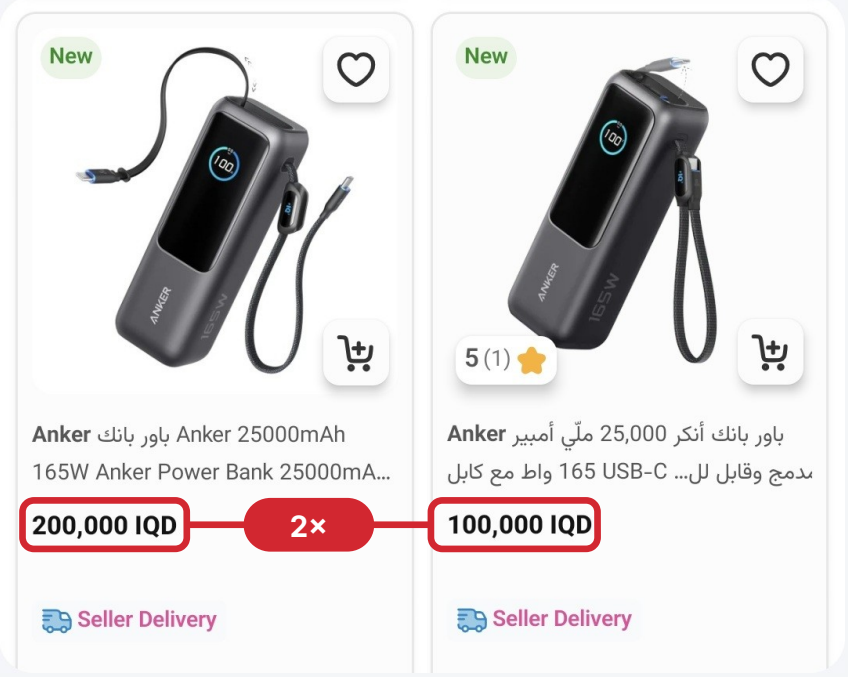
Shakir Bashar

5 November 2026

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Problem

Online in Iraq, you can't know the real price before you buy.



Same search. Same screen. Same model.

Anker 25,000 mAh · 165 W

Miswag search grid

Seller 1	100,000 IQD
Seller 2	200,000 IQD

2× the price

same power bank

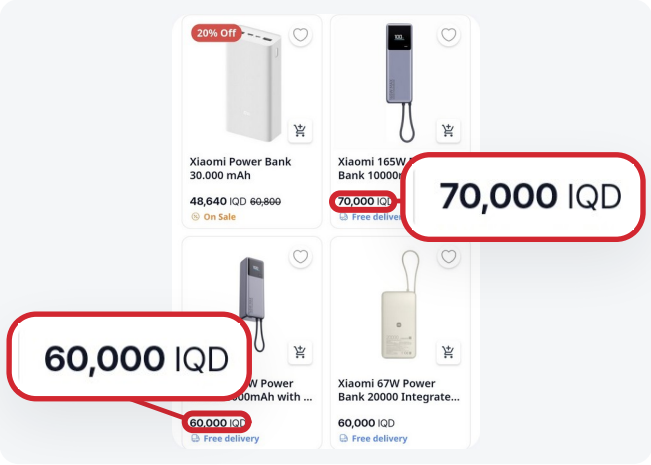
+100,000 IQD on the same screen

Miswag app, 20 Oct 2026. Seller names blurred.

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Problem · evidence

And it's the whole market.



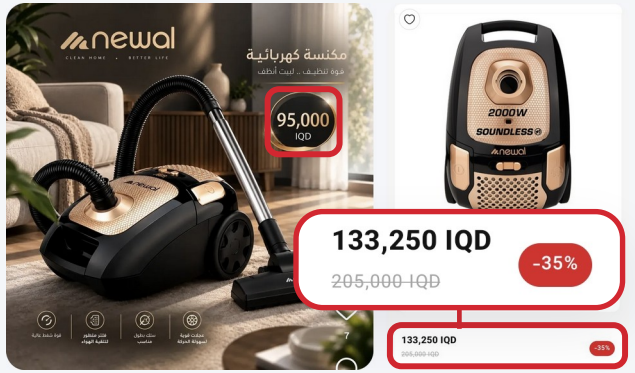
Same item, listed twice

60,000 vs 70,000 IQD



No price — just 'DM us'

Buyer asks: “How much?”



A fake 35% discount

95,000 IG vs 133,250 “deal”

97% **of 179 shoppers we surveyed see this.**

Screenshots Sep–Oct 2026 (seller names blurred) · Cheapify market survey, n=199 (179 shoppers, 20 merchants), Sep–Oct 2026.

Solution

Cheapify puts every seller's real price for the same product on one page.



Anker Power Bank 25,000 mAh · 165 W

One page · every verified seller

Seller	Item	Delivery	Doorstep total	Arrives	
Store A · Duhok	92,000	+3,000	**95,000 IQD**	Today	BEST VALUE
Store D · Zakho	91,000	+5,000	**96,000 IQD**	1–2 days	
Store B · Duhok	99,000	+3,000	**102,000 IQD**	Today	
Store C · Duhok	121,000	+3,000	**124,000 IQD**	Today	

Best Value rules

1. **Lowest doorstep total**
2. **Fastest delivery**
3. **Best seller rating**

Ranking can't be bought.

Illustration — store names and prices are examples.

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Value proposition

Shoppers save. Merchants sell.

For shoppers

- **Every price, side by side**
- **Order in 30 seconds**
- **Cash on delivery or card**

For merchants

- **Orders, not interrogations**
- **Free dashboard**
- **Fair, low fee**

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Target market

Duhok first: about 890,000 people online.

Iraq
46.1M
people
39.6M online · $1.32B a year

Duhok governorate
1.60M
people
≈ 1.34M online · ≈ $46M a year

Launch area
≈ 890K
online
Duhok · Semel · Zakho
of 1.06M people

≈ $30M
spent online a year
in the launch area

~390
regular shoppers to break even
≈ 585 orders a month
≈ $117K a year
of orders through Cheapify
0.4% of ≈ $30M

Population: 2024 census (Ministry of Planning). Internet: DataReportal 2026. E-commerce: ECDB 2025. Duhok online (≈) = Iraq rate × population share. Break-even: 585 × 25,000 IQD × 12 ÷ 1,500.

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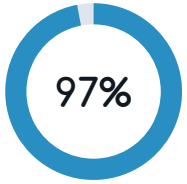
Target customers

Budget-conscious shoppers who already compare prices.

Shoppers

targeting plan

- Time-poor professionals — 23–38
- Household budget buyers — 26–48
- Students & deal hunters — 18–24

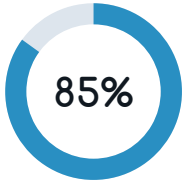


notice big price gaps on the same item

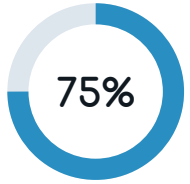
Merchants

Duhok social shops

- Social-commerce sellers — IG · FB · TikTok
- 1,500 – 50,000 followers — 20–150 products
- 20 founding stores at launch — ~8 leads ready



sell on IG / FB



want to try Cheapify

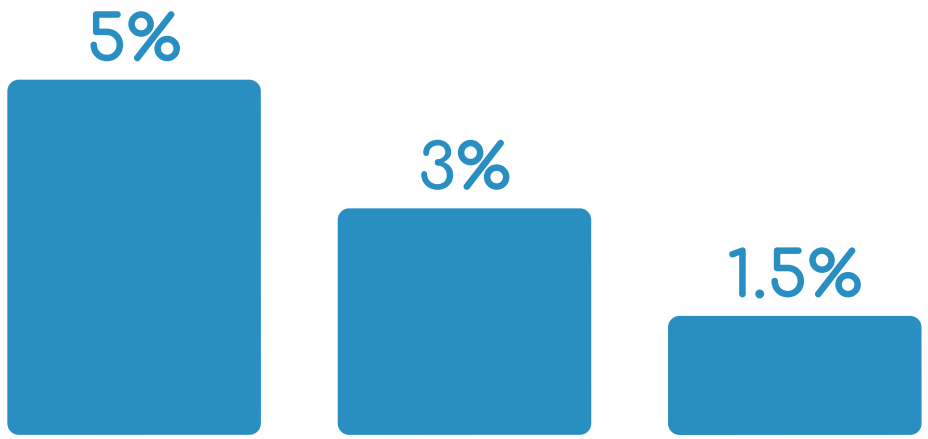
Age groups are our targeting plan — the survey did not ask age. Survey n=199 (179 shoppers, 20 merchants), Sep–Oct 2026.

Business model

We earn only when an order is delivered.

Our fee

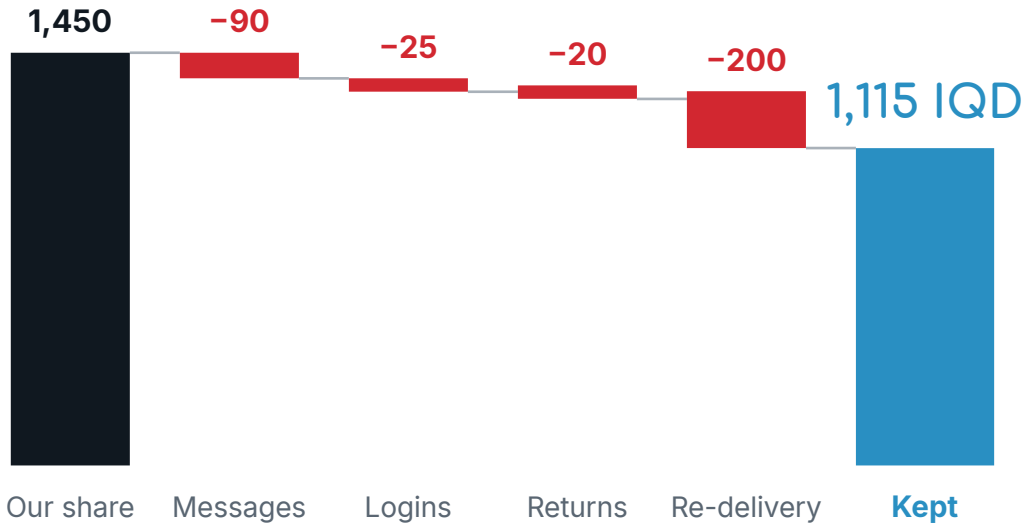
Lighter as prices rise



Typical 25,000 IQD order → 950 IQD fee + 500 delivery margin.

Per order

From our 1,450 IQD share to net profit



Example: 25,000 IQD item, cash on delivery, Duhok city; courier rate 2,500 IQD quoted by Fast Delivery (Duhok). Delivery margin applies once the courier contract is signed.

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Competitor analysis

Nobody else puts every seller on one page.

	Instagram / Facebook	Miswag	iBazzar	Elryan	Cheapify
Prices shown upfront	◐	✓	✓	✓	✓
One page per product	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Every seller compared	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Third-party sellers can join	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓

✓ yes ◐ partly ✗ no

Based on in-app screenshots (Sep–Oct 2026) and public platform information.

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Growth strategy

We grow on two sides: stores and shoppers.

Stores

- Signed in person · 20 stores
- 0% in month 1
- Free ads
- Their followers · 1.5k–50k each



Shoppers

- Targeted ads · $2,200
- Short videos
- Campus deals · 3 universities
- Waitlist & referrals · 52 ready

Duhok · Semel · Zakho → Erbil · Mosul · Sulaymaniyah → All of Iraq

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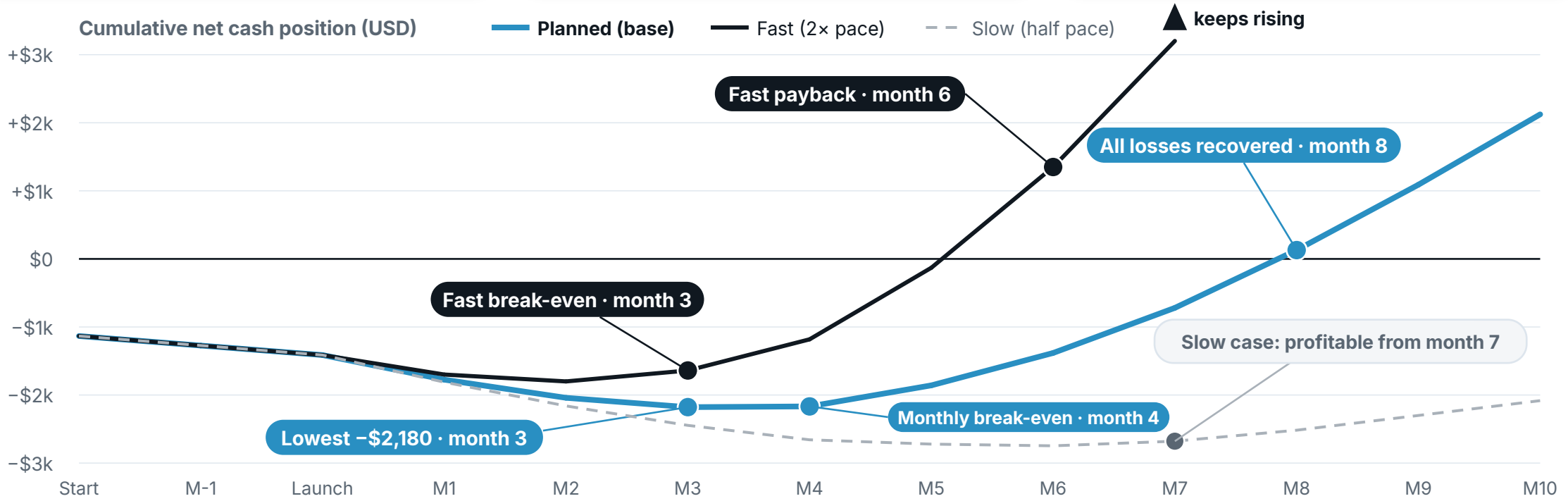
Financial feasibility

Profitable from month 4. Everything earned back by month 8.

Costs $435 / month
from month 6: $527

Break-even 585 orders / mo
≈ 390 regular shoppers

Payback month 8
fast case: month 6



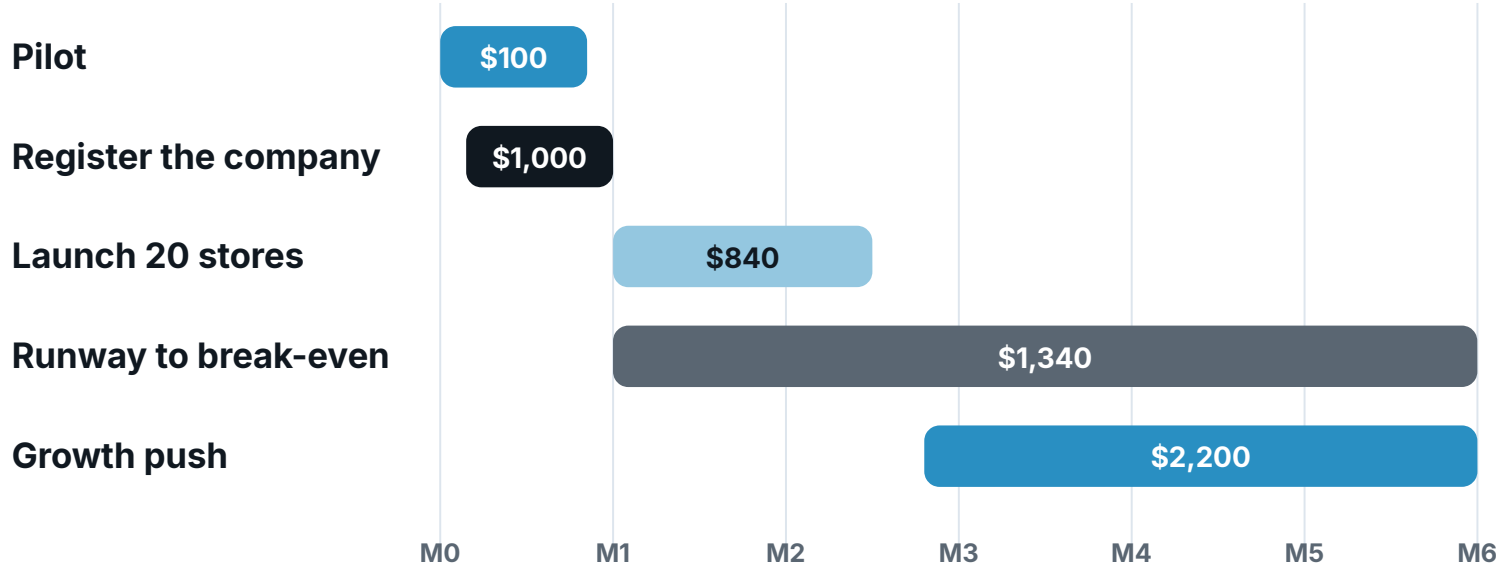
Planned: orders grow 100 → 2,000/month; Fast: 2× pace; Slow: half pace. Costs $435/month (652,000 IQD; $527 from month 6), incl. 1.7M IQD startup. USD at 1,500 IQD.

Funding

What $5,480 makes possible.

$5,480 total ask

When each dollar is spent (M0 → M6)



Less? Still a plan.

$3,280

Launches + slow-case runway

Pilot + registration + 20 stores + full $1,340 slow-case runway

$2,710

Launches + planned runway

Pilot + registration + 20 stores + $770 planned-case runway

No salaries. No developers. I build the platform myself.

Registration: official KRI fee schedule · USD at the CBI rate of 1,500 IQD.

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Thank You

The bright side of choosing.

getcheapify.com

Shakir Bashar · Founder

Scan to join the waitlist

capa.auk | CAPA AUK | capa@auk.edu.krd

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Appendix

Progressive fee schedule: lighter as prices rise

5% on the first 10,000 IQD · 3% on 10,001–100,000 · 1.5% above 100,000 — marginal brackets so a higher price never pays a higher rate.

Item price (IQD)	Cheapify fee (IQD)	Merchant keeps (IQD)	Effective fee rate
5,000	250	4,750	5.0%
10,000	500	9,500	5.0%
25,000 (typical order)	**950**	**24,050**	**3.8%**
45,000	1,550	43,450	3.4%
100,000	3,200	96,800	3.2%
150,000	3,950	146,050	2.6%
350,000	6,950	343,050	2.0%
1,200,000	19,700	1,180,300	1.6%

On a typical 25,000 IQD order, the merchant keeps 96.2% (24,050 IQD) and Cheapify earns 950 IQD.

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Appendix

Unit economics, payment methods & sensitivity

Per 25,000 IQD order (Duhok city, COD)	IQD
Platform fee (5% first 10k + 3% next 15k)	+950
Delivery margin (3,000 charged − 2,500 courier contract)	+500
WhatsApp alerts (−90) & OTP login codes (−25)	−115
Returns (−20) & failed-delivery re-attempts (−200)	−220
Kept per delivered order (COD base case)	**+1,115**

Payment method / sensitivity case	Gateway fee	Kept / order	Break-even
Cash on delivery (base case)	**0 IQD**	**1,115 IQD**	**~585 / mo**
SuperQi wallet (Qi 2026 promo; no door failure)	0 IQD (0%)	1,315 IQD	~496 / mo
FIB in-app QR (0.3% on 28k; no door failure)	~84 IQD	1,231 IQD	~530 / mo
Visa / Mastercard (≤1% CBI cap; no door failure)	≤280 IQD	1,035 IQD	~630 / mo
No courier contract signed (COD)	0 IQD	615 IQD	~1,060 / mo

Pre-paid orders remove the 200 IQD failed-delivery cost, so SuperQi and FIB QR earn even more per order than COD.

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Appendix

Three growth scenarios & low-point composition

Scenario	Orders at M6	Lowest cash point	Monthly break-even	All losses recovered
Fast (2× planned pace)	2,700 / month	−$1,800 (M2)	Month 3	Month 6
Planned (base case)	**1,350 / month**	**−$2,180 (M3)**	**Month 4**	**Month 8**
Slow (half the planned pace)	675 / month	−$2,750 (M6)	Month 7	~Month 20

Component of the −$2,180 (−3.27M IQD) planned low point	IQD	USD	Funded by
Startup costs (registration, 20 store kits, labels, app stores)	1,700,000	$1,133	Grant (lines 2 & 3)
Two development months before launch (M-2, M-1)	420,000	$280	Founder (pre-award)
Operating losses M1–M3 (planned pace; slow case is $1,340)	1,147,625	$765	Grant (line 5 runway)
Total planned cash low point (Month 3)	**3,267,625**	**$2,178**	**Each cost funded once**

Even at half the planned order pace (Slow case), losses stay capped by our $435/mo burn and turn profitable in Month 7.

Appendix

Market validation survey: 199 responses (Sep–Oct 2026)

Shoppers (n = 179)

97%	notice price gaps on the exact same item (39% always see large gaps)
88%	would use a side-by-side comparison app (only 2% prefer DMs)
Top pains	untrusted/duplicate pages 52% · found cheaper after buying 47% · DM price interrogation 46%
~52 leads	actionable beta-waitlist contacts (38 phone numbers + 14 Instagram handles)

Merchants (n = 20)

85%	sell primarily on Instagram and Facebook
75%	want to try Cheapify (15% maybe depending on commission · 10% no)
Top pains	'price?' DMs 55% · random price undercutting 45% · own-app cost 35% · courier coordination 35%
~8 leads	validated pilot-store leads ready for in-person onboarding (target: 20 founding stores)

Limitations noted honestly: self-selected sample (168 AR / 21 EN / 10 KU) — the $100 hand-run pilot tests real buying.

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Appendix

Six documented price-variation cases in our market

Product	Lowest price	Highest price	Spread	Where captured
Anker 25K 165W power bank (flagship)	**90,000 IQD (IG)**	**200,000 IQD (Miswag)**	**+122%**	**Instagram, iBazzar, Miswag**
Hoco HX80 portable espresso maker	25,000 IQD (IG)	35,280 IQD (Miswag)	+41%	Instagram vs Miswag
Newal VAC-3510 2000W vacuum	95,000 IQD (IG)	133,250 IQD (Miswag)	+40%	Instagram vs Miswag ('−35%')
ASUS VA24EHF 24" monitor	135,000 IQD (Elryan)	163,350 IQD (Miswag)	+21%	Elryan vs Miswag
Xiaomi 165W 10,000 mAh power bank	60,000 IQD	70,000 IQD	+17%	Inside the same app (iBazzar)
Espresso machines (2 seller posts)	Hidden	Hidden	No price	Instagram ('call / DM to order')

Price gaps of 17% to 122% appear across both social sellers and major apps — even inside the same app's search screen.

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Appendix

Top operational risks and how we handle them

Risk	Mitigation built into the model
Slower shopper adoption than planned	**Model sized to conservative ramp; slow case (half pace) is covered by the $1,340 runway; $100 pilot validates demand first**
Buyers and sellers bypass the app	Low ~3.8% fee, no seller phone numbers on waybills, ratings and referral credits work only on-platform
Courier contract or registration delayed	Registration is funded in M0 right after the pilot; second courier quote in hand; even without the 500 margin, orders stay +615 IQD positive
Failed COD deliveries ('not at home')	200 IQD/order budgeted for re-delivery; one free re-attempt; 3 failures disable COD for that buyer; WhatsApp pre-dispatch check
Late COD cash transfer from courier	Contract sets a 24h transfer target; merchant payouts release only after 48h return window AND courier transfer

Every top risk is addressed before scale: low burn ($435/mo), $100 validation gate, and strict COD custody rules.

Appendix

End-to-end order, payment & return flow

1. Checkout

Cash on delivery or card; doorstep total upfront

2. Store accepts

Dashboard + WhatsApp alert; 2h SLA

3. Sealed pack

Opaque mailer + waybill; security tape ≥50k

4. Courier pickup

Fast Delivery (Duhok) picks up same day

5. Doorstep delivery

Courier collects COD cash & transfers electronically

6. Auto payout

Merchant paid 48h after delivery, minus fee

48-hour return window

Faulty / wrong item: merchant pays return shipping. Buyer remorse (unopened): buyer pays 3,000 IQD return fee.

Zero cash handled by Cheapify

Courier transfers COD funds electronically to Cheapify; card/wallet orders settle via FIB / SuperQi / Switch gateway.

Cheapify never touches physical cash, and paying merchants after the 48-hour return window avoids clawbacks.

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Appendix

How we sized the Duhok launch market

Metric	Value	Calculation	Source
Launch-area population	1,062,224	Duhok 497,029 + Zakho 398,876 + Semel 166,319	2024 national census
Duhok governorate population	1,599,871	All 7 districts of Duhok governorate	2024 national census
Launch-area internet users (est.)	≈ 0.89M	1,062,224 × 83.8% Iraq internet penetration	DataReportal 2026 rate
Launch-area online shopping (est.)	≈ $30M / year	2.30% share of Iraq population × $1,317M Iraq e-commerce	ECDB Iraq 2025
Break-even order volume	~585 orders / mo	652,000 IQD monthly burn ÷ 1,115 IQD kept per order (~$117k/yr GMV)	Cheapify financial model
Regular shoppers at break-even	**~390 shoppers**	**585 orders/month ÷ 1.5 orders/month per active shopper (≈ 0.4% of market)**	**Cheapify financial model**

Break-even requires only ~390 regular shoppers (~585 orders/month) out of ~890,000 internet users in Duhok, Semel and Zakho.

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Funding detail: 6 computed lines & monthly release

#	Grant component	USD	IQD	When	Derivation
1	Hand-run concierge pilot	$100	150,000	M0	15–20 real orders on MVP before registration (~5–7k IQD/order)
2	Company registration & filing	$1,000	1,500,000	M0	154.5k Companies Reg. + 1,140k Chamber (English) + ~200k filing
3	Launch setup (20 stores + apps)	$710	1,061,000	M1	20 kits × 40k (800k) + labels (75k) + Apple ($99) + Google ($25)
4	Founding-store 0% month-1 offer	$130	190,000	M1–M2	0% fee in M1: ~200 orders × 950 IQD typical fee waived
5	Operating runway (slow-case cap)	$1,340	1,998,400	M1–M6	Slow-case monthly loss cap: 596k + 524k + 429k + 318k + 95k + 37k
6	Growth marketing push	$2,200	3,300,000	M3–M6	4 months × 825k IQD ($550/mo) ads + campus (~900 shoppers)
	Total grant request	**$5,480**	**8,199,400**	**M0–M6**	**Exact IQD = $5,466 at 1,500 CBI rate; each line rounded up to $10**

M0	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
$1,100	$1,180	$414	$836	$762	$613	$575
Pilot + registration	Setup + offer + runway	Offer + runway	Runway + ads start	Break-even + ads	Runway + ads	Self-funding

Runway is released only against actual monthly losses — the planned case uses ~$765 of the $1,340 cap.